

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Is it a manual, a guide, or a set of instructions?



Learning Outcome:

Designs a user manual that fulfills both the IT solution needs and the client requirements.

Understand how to write a good user manual.

Can Do Statements:

- I can talk about the difference between manuals, guides and instructions.
- I can describe a user manual structure and components.

Ask your partner:

- In your opinion, is it important to read manuals before using the products? Why?
- How do you think a guide can help you to understand a product?





Let's Explore!

Jenny and Ben are about to assemble a computer.



Instructions: Read the text below.

- Jenny:** Hey, I hope this new computer comes with instructions to assemble it. I don't know how to put its parts together.
- Ben:** Instructions? Or you mean a manual?
- Jenny:** I'm not sure. A guide probably? I'm confused about that too. What's the difference?
- Ben:** Well, the terms are usually misused and confused. A manual usually refers to a formal document which provides information about a product and its maintenance. Manufacturers usually hand in an official manual with the product they sell. A guide refers to a written document, video, or booklet. It might contain very detailed information or just generic features of the product. The term guide is sometimes preferred by companies since the word manual sounds a bit too formal.
- Jenny:** So, what about instructions?
- Ben:** They are a bit more generic. Instructions are directions or steps on how to do something. Generally, manuals and guides include instructions which refer to processes in assembling or getting something done.
- Jenny:** Oh! So, we'll probably get a manual with this computer to tell us what to do before starting it. What shall we find in the manual?
- Ben:** Well, it depends. All manuals can be different; however, there are certain common elements. The most usual elements are the table of contents, a copyright notice, terms and conditions, and graphics and images if necessary. Of course, instructions and procedures are necessary in the body of the manual as it is what users expect to find.
- Jenny:** And if users have further questions?
- Ben:** In case users want to have additional information, manufacturers usually include a customer support line to help them solve their questions with a representative.
- Jenny:** That was a good explanation. Now, I understand the difference better.

**Let's Practice!****Manual Features**

Instructions: Read the text. Circle the correct word to complete the sentence.

1. We'll probably get a manual with this computer to tell us what (to do /doing /do) before starting it.
2. It's a set of directions or steps on how (doing /do /to do) something.
3. In case users want to know (who / how / where) to talk to for additional information, the manual includes several contact numbers.
4. I don't know how (put / putting / to put) its parts together.
5. It might contain very detailed information about (what / who / when) to call maintenance service too.

**Let's Practice!****Manuals vs Instructions**

Instructions: Select the correct answer.

1. If we see specific written or illustrated steps on how to do something, we then understand these are... (You need these directions to assemble something sometimes.)
a. booklet b. instructions c. video
2. If the little book that comes with the device you bought _____, it is a booklet.. (It is a short text.)
a. has a lot of pages b. has few pages c. is a video
3. If you buy a new product, you will probably need this document which provides you with information about the product. (It is normally a written document.)
a. instruction b. term c. manual
4. If you need to play _____, what you see is probably a guide. (It can appear in different formats.)
a. a video b. a presentation c. a computer
5. If you read a new product's manual, you will find information about the product and its _____. (This is important to guarantee the life of the product.)
a. maintenance b. damage c. complaints
6. What can people do if they have doubts with their product? (Think of someone who to contact for assistance.)
a. Call the support line in the manual b. See the table content in the instructions c. Read the terms and conditions





Extension Activity

Designing a Manual

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Search information about user manuals.
- Imagine you're going to design a user manual. Write 5 parts you would include.
- Read the manual to the class. Tell the class to identify the elements in your manual.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I search information about manuals.
- I write a manual.
- I mention 5 parts of the manual.
- I read my manual to the class.

☐	☐
☐	☐
☐	☐
☐	☐



Target Words

- manufacturer** (noun): the person who makes a product.
 e.g. In case users want to know additional information. Manufacturers usually include a customer support line to help them solve their questions.
- notice** (noun): an announcement or warning.
 e.g. The most usual elements are the table of contents, a copyright notice.
- representative** (noun): a person in a line that provides support to customers.
 e.g. Manufacturers usually include a customer support line to help them solve their questions with a representative.

- booklet** (noun): a book with a few pages.
 e.g. A guide refers either to a written document, video or booklet.
- further** (adverb): more or additional.
 e.g. And if users have further questions?
- maintenance** (noun): the act of keeping something maintained.
 e.g. A manual usually refers to a formal document which provides information about a product and its maintenance.



Learning Points

Questions within sentences: How to / Where to / What to + Verb- all of them

You can use question words followed by the infinitive form of a verb to request specific information.

This pattern is sometimes followed by certain verbs or phrases.

Some of them are:

- Learn
- Discuss
- Have information on
- Know
- Think about
- Give an idea of

Always use the base form of the verb in this pattern.

For example:

- *Learn how **to write***
- *Discuss what **to eat***
- *Have information on where **to go***
- *Know how **to reply***
- *Think about what **to choose***
- *Give an idea of what **to drink***

Examples

- *It's a set of directions or steps on how to do something.*
- *So we'll probably get a manual with this computer to tell us what to do before starting it.*





Learning Points

User Manual components

Although the terms are usually overlap, there are certain differences among them.

- **Manual:** It refers to a written document which provides information about a product, its maintenance and assistance. It is an official document usually provided by the manufacturer.
- **Guide:** This is a more generic term and it refers to any type of material which gives information about a product. It might be a video or a booklet. You might find a wide range, from very basic ones to complex and detailed guides.
- **Instructions:** This is the most generic term of all. It refers to the directions or steps on how to do something. Instructions might be included on a manual or a guide. They can be simple words to describe something.

Examples

- *A guide refers either to a written document, a video or a booklet.*
- *Generally, manuals and guides include instructions, which refer to processes on assembling or getting something done.*